

Comparison and Contrast:

Texts That Show Similarity and Difference

Understand What Comparison and Contrast Are

Comparison is writing that shows the similarities among subjects—people, ideas, situations, or items; **contrast** shows the differences between them. In conversation, people often use the word *compare* to mean either compare or contrast, but as you work through this chapter, the terms will be separated.

Compare

=

Similarities

Contrast

=

Differences

Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast

- 1 It compares and/or contrasts for a purpose—to help readers make a decision, to help them understand the subjects, or to show the writer's understanding of the subjects.
- 2 It presents several parallel, important points of comparison/contrast.
- 3 It develops points of comparison/contrast fairly, with supporting details for both subjects.
- 4 It arranges points in a logical order.

In the following paragraph, written for a biology course, the numbers and colors correspond to the Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast.

4 Points arranged in logical order.

1 Although frogs and toads are closely related, they differ in appearance, in habitat, and in behavior. 2 The first major difference is in the creatures' physical characteristics. 3 Whereas most frogs have smooth, slimy skin that helps them move through water, toads tend to have rough, bumpy skin suited to drier surroundings. Also, whereas frogs have long, muscular hind legs that help them leap away from predators or toward food, most toads have shorter legs and, therefore, less ability to move quickly. Another physical characteristic of frogs and toads is their bulging eyes, which help them see in different directions. This ability is important, because neither creature can turn its head to look for food or spot a predator. However, frogs' eyes may protrude more than toads'. 2 The second major difference between frogs and toads is their choice of habitat. 3 Frogs tend to live in or near ponds, lakes, or other sources of water. In contrast, toads live mostly in drier areas, such as gardens, forests, and fields. But, like frogs, they lay their eggs in water. The third major difference between frogs and toads concerns their behavior. Whereas frogs may be active during the day or at night, most toads keep a low profile until nighttime. Some biologists believe that it is nature's way of making up for toads' inability to escape from danger as quickly as frogs can. At night, toads are less likely to be spotted by predators. 2 Finally, although both frogs and toads tend to live by themselves, toads, unlike frogs, may form groups while they are hibernating. 1 Both creatures can teach us a lot about how animals adapt to their environments, and studying them is a lot of fun.

Teaching Tip: Photographs are a helpful way to begin classroom discussion of comparison and contrast. Although a variety of photographs could be used, consider showing Cézanne's painting *The Card Players* and Jeff Wall's contemporary photograph with the same title.

Many situations require you to understand similarities and differences, whether you are reading or writing. In college, a history textbook may contrast the leadership styles of two presidents to explain why one was more effective. In a pharmacy course, you might compare and contrast the side effects of two drugs prescribed for the same illness. At work, you might read product reviews that compare and contrast two potential purchases, or you could be asked to write an analysis that contrasts this year's sales with last year's. In everyday life, you might read a comparison between candidates for the local school board, or you might compare restaurants when making a recommendation for a friend. All of these activities require an understanding of comparison and contrast.

In college, assignments may include the words *compare* and *contrast*, but they might also use phrases such as *discuss similarities and differences*, *how is X like (or unlike) Y?*, or *what do X and Y have in common?* Also, assignments may use only the word *compare*.

Reading Comparison and Contrast

When you are previewing a text, look for the following clues that the writer has used comparison or contrast:

- Charts or graphics that present two subjects side by side, or pairs of images

- Titles or subtitles that mention *similarities* (comparison) or *differences* (contrast)
- Transitions, such as *in contrast* or *on the other hand*, that suggest contrast
- Transitions, such as *in the same way* or *similarly*, that suggest comparison

Once you have determined that a text is comparing, contrasting, or both, consider why the writer has chosen these particular subjects, and make a note of the points of comparison and/or contrast. As you read, consider whether the writer treats both subjects fairly: has the writer provided equal attention to both subjects? Is there enough detail about both subjects? Finally, consider using a graphic organizer (see p. 221) to take notes on the reading.

Comparison and Contrast in the Classroom: Reviewing for a Test

Paulo is taking an introductory biology class. He is reviewing for a test on the different macromolecules found in living things, which include proteins, carbohydrates, lipids, and nucleic acids. A friend who took the class in a previous semester gave Paulo some advice: prepare to compare and contrast carbohydrates and proteins.

Paulo was confused. Nothing in his notes mentioned comparisons or contrasts, and the textbook had only one paragraph about each type of macromolecule. Paulo began to think about what his friend said, and he remembered the Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast from his English class. Carbohydrates and proteins are important to living things, but they function in different ways. Paulo began to look for points of comparison and contrast—in other words, the areas in which the molecules are similar and the areas in which they are different. As he skimmed each paragraph from the text, he saw one area of comparison (similarity) and three areas of contrast (difference).

Paulo used a chart, a type of graphic organizer, to help him focus:

Name of Macromolecule	Polymers	Monomers	Function	Synthesis and Digestion Reactions
Carbohydrates	1. Simple (i.e., sucrose) 2. Complex (i.e., starch)	Monosaccharides	Serve as energy source for cells Store energy in plants	Dehydration and hydrolysis
Proteins	1. Structural (i.e., tubulins) 2. Functional (i.e., enzymes)	Amino acids	Provide structure to the cell Catalyze chemical reactions	Dehydration and hydrolysis

By arranging his notes to show the points of difference between each type of molecule, Paulo felt confident he could answer his exam question: compare and contrast carbohydrates and proteins.

PRACTICE 11-1**Identify Comparison and Contrast in Textbooks**

1. Explore your textbook. In Chapters 7 through 13 of this textbook, there are charts titled "Paragraph vs. Essays" (see pp. 228–29 in this chapter, for example). The abbreviation "vs." (for "versus") often indicates a comparison or contrast. Do these charts show similarities, differences, or both? Can you find another example of a comparison/contrast chart in this textbook?
2. Do an Internet search to find examples of common graphic organizers used for comparison and contrast (such as T-diagrams or Venn diagrams). Then see if you can find examples of these graphic organizers in one of your textbooks. How can the graphic organizer help you understand the material more effectively? Explain.

First Basic: Main Point in Comparison and Contrast

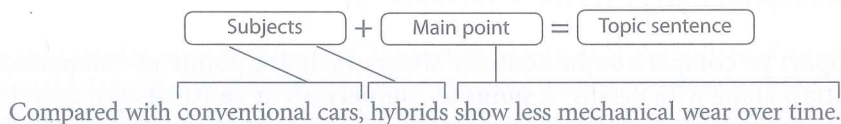
The main point in comparison and contrast should state the subjects being compared or contrasted, and it should reflect the writer's purpose: to evaluate which subject is better or more appropriate, help readers make a decision, or help readers understand the subjects better. Writers do not always state the main point directly; therefore, readers may need to infer the thesis or topic sentence. To help you identify a main point, complete the following sentence:

The writer compared/contrasted these subjects to show that . . .

If you are writing a comparison/contrast, complete the following sentence to discover your main point:

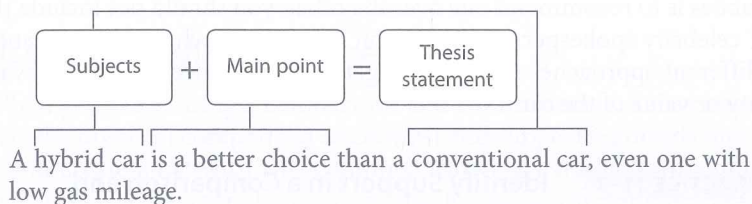
I want my readers to _____ after reading my comparison/contrast.

Here is an example of a topic sentence for a paragraph:



The purpose of this sentence is to help readers decide which type of car to buy.

Remember that the topic for an essay can be a little broader than one for a paragraph.



Whereas the topic sentence focuses on the mechanical advantages of hybrid cars, the thesis statement sets up a broader discussion of these cars' benefits. Most writers will compare or contrast, but not both, in a paragraph; in an essay, a writer may choose to discuss similarities and differences.

PRACTICE 11-2

Identify Parts of a Comparison and Contrast Main Point

For each of the following topic sentences, underline the subjects being compared or contrasted and double underline the main idea.

1. My two daughters have completely different personalities.
2. U.S. military involvement in Vietnam and Iraq shared several significant features.
3. Grocery stores in wealthy suburbs are much better than those in poor inner-city neighborhoods.
4. Wal-Mart and Target really are not that different in terms of merchandise quality, business practices, and effect on local economies.

Second Basic: Major Support in Comparison and Contrast

Support in comparison or contrast always includes points of comparison/contrast along with details. A **point of comparison or contrast** is an aspect or feature that is relevant to both subjects. For example, if you are comparing two automobiles, points of comparison or contrast could include gas mileage, speed capabilities, and interior comfort. The specific details would explain these three features for both subjects. In the paragraph contrasting frogs and toads (p. 216), the points of comparison/contrast are *appearance*, *habitat*, and *behavior*.

The points of comparison and/or contrast that you choose should relate directly to the purpose of your essay. For example, if your purpose in contrasting two automobiles is to recommend one over the other, you should not include the companies' celebrity spokespersons as a point of contrast; while the companies may have different approaches to advertising, those differences are not relevant to the quality or value of the car.

PRACTICE 11-3

Identify Support in a Comparison and Contrast Essay

Identify the points of contrast (major support), using a chart, in the essay on page 229.

PRACTICE 11-4

Find Points of Comparison or Contrast and Write Main Ideas

Below are some subjects that could be compared or contrasted. List some points of comparison or contrast for each. Then, write a topic sentence for each list. The first one has been done for you.

1. **Example:** Contrast hair lengths.

Long Hair	Short Hair
takes a long time to dry	dries quickly
can be worn a lot of ways	only one way to wear it
does not need to be cut often	needs to be cut every five weeks
gets tangled, needs brushing	low maintenance

Topic Sentence: Short and long hairstyles offer different options for busy college students.

2. Contrast two sports, such as basketball and soccer.
3. Compare the same two sports.
4. Compare or contrast two heroes.
5. Compare or contrast two dictionary or translator apps.

Third Basic: Points of Comparison or Contrast with Details

In the sample essay on page 229, the writer mentions three points of contrast between hybrid and conventional cars: benefits such as tax breaks, long-term savings, and environment impacts. The writer's purpose is to show why he is buying a hybrid vehicle; in order to accomplish this purpose, the writer provides evidence—details, examples, descriptions, and facts. The writer should also be careful to provide details fairly and equally between both subjects. Giving extensive information about the gas mileage in a hybrid vehicle, for example, without providing similar data about the conventional car does not help the reader assess the importance of these numbers.

Using a Graphic Organizer

When you are reading a comparison and contrast essay, it may help you recognize the points of comparison or contrast and supporting details more effectively if you create a list with two columns, showing parallel points of comparison or contrast. Consider the chart below, based on the sample paragraph from page 216.

Frogs	Toads
Differences in Appearance	
Skin is smoother and slimier	Skin is rough and bumpy
Back legs are long and muscular	Legs are shorter
Frogs' eyes stick out	Toads' eyes don't stick out as far
Differences in Habitat	
Live in or near water	Live in drier areas (fields, forests, gardens)
Differences in Behavior	
Active day and night	Active mainly at night
Live alone	Live alone but may get into a group during hibernation

The same strategy (making a chart) can also be used to find support when you are prewriting for comparison/contrast. Using a graphic organizer like this one also helps writers make sure that they have enough information about both

subjects. Good comparison/contrast presents equal amounts of information about both subjects.

Here is one student's prewriting, based on this topic sentence:

The two credit cards I am considering offer different financial terms.

Big Card

no annual fee

\$1 fee per cash advance

30 days before interest charges begin

15.5% finance charge

Mega Card

\$35 annual fee

\$1.50 fee per cash advance

25 days before interest charges begin

17.9% finance charge

PRACTICE 11-5 Identify Supporting Details

The following paragraph is from the essay on page 229. Underline the point of contrast (major support). Number the key supporting details and then answer this question: has the writer provided enough information about both types of cars?

The second advantage of hybrid cars over conventional cars is that they save money over the long term. In addition to using less fuel, hybrids show less mechanical wear over time, reducing maintenance costs. When braking, drivers of conventional cars rely completely on the friction of the brake pads to come to a stop. As a result, brakes wear down over time, sometimes rather quickly. Additionally, these vehicles burn gas even while idling, making the engine use unnecessary energy and fuel. In contrast, when hybrid drivers hit the brakes, the car's motor goes into reverse, slowing the car and allowing the driver to place less strain on the brakes. Then, as the driver enters stop-and-start traffic in town, the electric motor takes over from the gas engine, improving energy efficiency during idling and reducing engine wear.

PRACTICE 11-6 Write Supporting Details

Write three or more supporting details for each point of comparison or contrast you wrote in Practice 11-4, page 220.

Fourth Basic: Organization in Comparison and Contrast

Comparison/contrast can be organized in one of two ways: A **point-by-point** organization presents one point of comparison or contrast between the subjects and then moves to the next point. (See the essay model on p. 229.) A **whole-to-whole** organization presents all the points of comparison or contrast for one subject and then all the points for the next subject. (See the paragraph model on p. 228.) Recognizing the organization can help you find main ideas and major supporting details as you read.

When you are writing, consider which organization will best explain the similarities or differences to your readers. Whichever organization you choose, stay with it throughout your writing.

Point-by-Point Graphic Organizer

1st Point of Comparison or Contrast

Subject 1: Point 1 with details

Subject 2: Point 1 with details

2nd Point of Comparison or Contrast

Subject 1: Point 2 with details

Subject 2: Point 2 with details

3rd Point of Comparison or Contrast

Subject 1: Point 3 with details

Subject 2: Point 3 with details

Whole-by-Whole Graphic Organizer

Subject 1: Points of Comparison and Contrast

Point 1 with details

Point 2 with details

Point 3 with details

Subject 2: Points of Comparison and Contrast

Point 1 with details

Point 2 with details

Point 3 with details

PRACTICE 11-7

Recognize Patterns of Organization in Comparison and Contrast

1. Is the sample paragraph about frogs and toads (p. 216) organized point-by-point or whole-to-whole? How do you know?
2. Is the sample student paragraph (p. 216) organized point-by-point or whole-to-whole? How do you know?
3. Is the paragraph on coffeehouses in Practice 11-9 (p. 226) organized point-by-point or whole-to-whole? How do you know?

PRACTICE 11-8 Organize Comparison and Contrast Essays

The first outline that follows is for a comparison paper using a whole-to-whole organization. Reorganize the ideas, and create a new outline (outline 2) using a point-by-point organization. The first blank in outline 2 has been filled in for you.

The third outline is for a contrast paper using a point-by-point organization. Reorganize the ideas, and create a new outline (outline 4) using a whole-to-whole organization. The first blank in outline 4 has been partially filled in for you.

1. Comparison paper using whole-to-whole organization

Main point: My daughter is a lot like I was at her age.

a. Me

Not interested in school

Good at sports

Hard on myself

b. My daughter

Does well in school but doesn't study much or do more than the minimum

Plays in a different sport each season

When she thinks she has made a mistake, she gets upset with herself

2. Comparison paper using point-by-point organization

Main point: My daughter is a lot like I was at her age.

a. Interest in school

Me: Not interested in school

My daughter: Does well in school but doesn't study or do more than the minimum

b. Sports

Me: Good at sports

My daughter: Plays a different sport each season

c. Attitude toward self

Me: hard on myself

My daughter: gets upset with herself when she thinks she has made a mistake

3. Contrast paper using point-by-point organization

Main point: My new computer is a great improvement over my old one.

- a. Weight and portability
New computer: small and light
Old computer: heavy, not portable
- b. Speed
New computer: fast
Old computer: slow
- c. Cost
New computer: inexpensive
Old computer: expensive

4. Contrast paper using whole-to-whole organization

Main point: My new computer is a great improvement over my old one.

- a. New computer
small and light, fast, inexpensive
- b. Old computer
heavy, not portable, slow, expensive

In a point-by-point comparison/contrast essay, writers often organize points by **order of importance**, meaning that the most important point is saved for last. This strategy is used in the essay model on page 229.

Transitions in comparison/contrast move readers from one subject to another and from one point of comparison or contrast to the next. Pay attention to transitions when you are reading; the transitions will signal when the writer is making a comparison, a contrast, or a new point.

Common Transitions in Comparison and Contrast

	Adjective + Noun	Conjunctive Adverbials	Subordinating Conjunctions	Prepositions
Comparison	one similarity another similarity both subjects	similarly likewise in the same way	just as	like similar to
Contrast	one difference another difference the most important difference	on the other hand in contrast however	while although whereas	unlike different from

PRACTICE 11-9 Use Transitions in Comparison and Contrast

Read the paragraph that follows, and fill in the blanks with transitions. You are not limited to the ones listed in the preceding box. **Answers may vary.**
Possible answers are shown.

Modern coffee shops share many similarities with the coffeehouses that opened hundreds of years ago in the Middle East and Europe. One similarity is that the coffeehouses of history, like modern cafés, were popular places to socialize. In sixteenth-century Constantinople (now Istanbul, Turkey) and in seventeenth- and eighteenth-century London, customers shared stories, information, and opinions about current events, politics, and personal matters. The knowledge shared at London coffeehouses led customers to call these places “Penny Universities,” a penny being the price of admission. Another similarity is that the old coffeehouses, like today’s coffee shops, were often places of business. However, although most of today’s coffee-shop customers work quietly on their laptops, customers of the old shops openly, and sometimes loudly, discussed business and sealed deals. In fact, for more than seventy years, traders for the London Stock Exchange operated out of coffeehouses. The most important similarity between the old coffeehouses and modern coffee shops is that they both increased the demand for coffee and places to drink it. In 1652, a former servant from western Turkey opened the first coffeehouse in London. As a result of its popularity, many more coffeehouses soon sprouted up all over the city, and within a hundred years there were more than five hundred coffeehouses in London. Similarly, in recent years the popularity of Starbucks, and its shops, spread rapidly throughout the United States.

PRACTICE 11-10 Reorganize Paragraph Using Point-by-Point Order

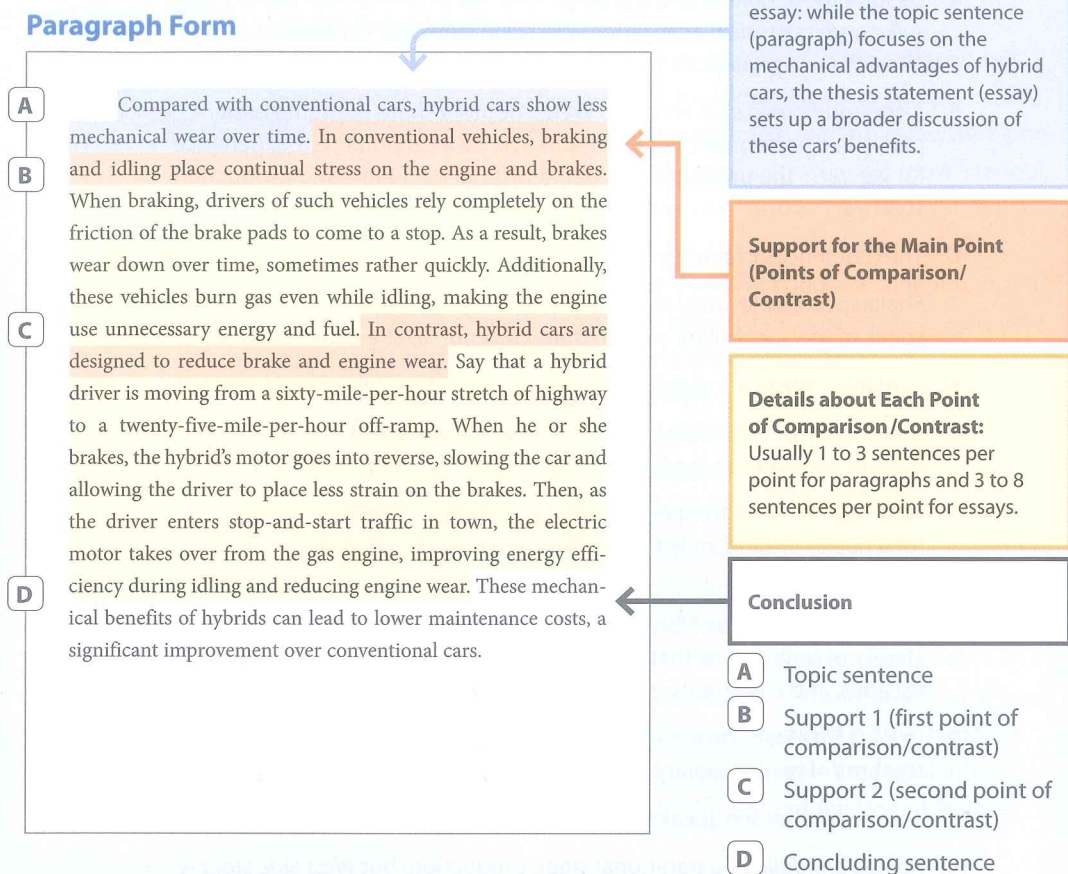
The sentences of the following point-by-point paragraph are not in the correct order. Identify the topic sentence (TS) and number the remaining sentences in the correct order. Circle transitions which help you to order the paragraph.

1. The scenes reflect noble society at that early time: there are castles, courts, feasts, and tapestries. **2**
2. Tony, like Romeo, says goodnight: “Always you, every thought I’ll ever know, everywhere I go, you’ll be.” **8**

3. For example, Romeo says, "Good night, good night! parting is such sweet sorrow, That I shall say good night till it be morrow." 6
4. Despite these differences, the tragic love story behind both *Romeo and Juliet* and its musical adaptation, *West Side Story*, has captivated audiences for many years. 12
5. Although *Romeo and Juliet* and *West Side Story* share the same basic plot, a live performance of either one will be a very different experience for viewers: the productions differ in setting, language, and production style. TS
6. The differences in setting lead to differences in language. 4
7. Shakespeare's play may sound foreign to modern ears, as the characters speak in the vocabulary and rhythms common to the early 1600s. 5
8. Perhaps a most critical difference, however, is in the style of production. 9
9. Written in the 1590s, Shakespeare's play *Romeo and Juliet* is set in Verona, Italy, during the late Middle Ages or early Renaissance. 1
10. Whether the lines are spoken or sung, audience members will hope for a happy ending, only to discover the lovers are ultimately united in death. 13
11. In contrast, *West Side Story*, written and set in the 1950s, reflects the streets of New York at that time: small apartments, rooftops, fire escapes, and city streets. 3
12. In *West Side Story*, however, characters speak with the language and rhythms of contemporary American English. 7
13. Thus, while Romeo speaks his goodbye, while Tony sings his. 11
14. *Romeo and Juliet* is a traditional stage production, but *West Side Story* is a Broadway musical in which a number of key scenes include singing and dancing, and it is generally performed with a live orchestra. 10

Paragraphs vs. Essays in Comparison and Contrast

For more on the important features of comparison and contrast, see the Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast on page 215.



Think Critically as You Read and Write Comparison and Contrast

Ask yourself when reading . . .

- Can I identify the writer's purpose?
- Can I identify the writer's main idea?
- Has the writer presented the similarities and/or differences fairly and evenly?
- Is there any evidence of bias? (For more about bias, see Chapter 13).
- Can I identify all the points of comparison and/or contrast? Could I make a chart to show how the essay is organized?

Ask yourself when writing . . .

- Is my purpose clear? (to help readers make a decision or to understand the subjects being compared or contrasted?)
- Do I have clear points of comparison and/or contrast?
- If my information about similarities or differences feels "thin," might consulting outside sources help me find new details? (For more on finding and evaluating sources, see Chapter 14.)

Essay Form

1

Why Buy a Hybrid?

They are too expensive. For the last two years, while trying to keep my dying 1999 Chevy on the road, these words have popped into my head every time I have thought about purchasing a hybrid car. But now that I have done some research, I am finally convinced: A hybrid car is a better choice than a conventional car, even one with low gas mileage.

The first advantage of hybrid cars over conventional cars is that buyers can get tax breaks and other hybrid-specific benefits. Although federal tax credits for hybrid purchasers expired in 2010, several states, including Colorado, Louisiana, Maryland, and New Mexico, continue to offer such credits. Also, in Arizona, Florida, and several other states, hybrid drivers are allowed to use the less congested high-occupancy vehicle (HOV) lanes even if the driver is the only person on board. Additional benefits for hybrid drivers include longer warranties than those offered for conventional cars and, in some states and cities, rebates, reduced licensing fees, and free parking.

A

B

3

gas burned by conventional motor vehicles produces 20 pounds of carbon dioxide (CO₂), a greenhouse gas that is a major contributor to global warming. Because hybrid cars use about half as much gas as conventional vehicles, they reduce pollution and greenhouse gases by at least 50 percent. Some experts estimate that they reduce such emissions by as much as 80 percent. The National Resources Defense Council says that if hybrid vehicles are widely adopted, annual reductions in emissions could reach 450 million metric tons by the year 2050. This reduction would be equal to taking 82.5 million cars off the road.

Although hybrid cars are more expensive than conventional cars, they are well worth it. From an economic standpoint, they save on fuel and maintenance costs. But, to me, the best reasons for buying a hybrid are ethical: By switching to such a vehicle, I will help reduce my toll on the environment. So goodbye, 1999 Chevy, and hello, Toyota Prius!

E

2

None of these benefits are offered to drivers of conventional cars.

The second advantage of hybrid cars over conventional cars is that they save money over the long term. In addition to using less fuel, hybrids show less mechanical wear over time, reducing maintenance costs. When braking, drivers of conventional cars rely completely on the friction of the brake pads to come to a stop. As a result, brakes wear down over time, sometimes rather quickly. Additionally, these vehicles burn gas even while idling, making the engine use unnecessary energy and fuel. In contrast, when hybrid drivers hit the brakes, the car's motor goes into reverse, slowing the car and allowing the driver to place less strain on the brakes. Then, as the driver enters stop-and-start traffic in town, the electric motor takes over from the gas engine, improving energy efficiency during idling and reducing engine wear.

The most important benefit of hybrid cars over conventional cars is that they have a lower impact on the environment. Experts estimate that each gallon of

C

D

- A Thesis statement
- B Topic sentence 1 (first point of comparison/contrast)
- C Topic sentence 2 (second point of comparison/contrast)
- D Topic sentence 3 (third point of comparison/contrast)
- E Concluding paragraph

Reading and Writing Comparison and Contrast: Analyze and Respond to Text

Read and Analyze Student Comparison and Contrast

Said Ibrahim

Eyeglasses vs. Laser Surgery: Benefits and Drawbacks



- What do you expect to read, based on the title?
- What is your guiding question for reading this paragraph?



Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Comparison and Contrast Read and annotate this paragraph using these guidelines:

1. *Pay attention to vocabulary.* Use marginal notes, context clues, or a dictionary.
2. *Find the main point and underline it.* Remember that the main point shows the writer's purpose for comparing and/or contrasting two subjects. Try to identify the writer's purpose: is the author showing that one subject is better than the other, or is the writer trying to help the readers understand both subjects more fully?
3. *Identify supporting details and organizational strategies.* Number the points of comparison or contrast, circle the transitions, and determine whether the writer has organized the paragraph point-by-point or whole-to-whole.
4. *Ask questions and make connections.* Remember to connect the points of comparison/contrast to your own experiences and other things you have read.

Although both eyeglasses and laser surgery can address vision problems successfully, each approach has particular benefits and drawbacks. Whereas one pair of eyeglasses is reasonably priced in comparison with laser surgery, eyeglass prescriptions often change over time, requiring regular lens replacements. As a result, over the wearer's lifetime, costs of eyeglasses can exceed \$15,000. On the positive side, an accurate lens prescription results in clear vision with few or no side effects. Furthermore, glasses of just the right shape or color can be a great fashion accent. In contrast to eyeglasses, laser vision correction often has to be done only once. Consequently, although the costs average \$2,500 per eye, the patient can save thousands of dollars over the following years. On the downside, some recipients of laser surgery report difficulties seeing at night, dry eyes, or infections. Fortunately, these problems are fairly rare. The final advantage of laser surgery applies to those who are happy to forgo the fashion benefits of eyeglasses. Most laser-surgery patients no longer have to wear any glasses other than sunglasses until later in life. At that point, they may need reading glasses. All in all, we are fortunate to live in a time when there are many good options for vision correction. Choosing the right one is a matter of carefully weighing the pros and cons of each approach.



Review your reading. Make sure you can answer these questions:

1. What are Ibrahim's main point and purpose in this paragraph?
2. How has he organized the paragraph? How do you know?
3. Does the paragraph illustrate the Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast? Explain.



1. What specific details help Ibrahim develop the points of contrast? Has he provided enough details to make the points of contrast clear to the reader? Explain.
2. Based on the reading, which of the two options for correcting vision would you be more likely to choose? Why?

* * *

Rui Dai

A Whiff of Memory



1. Look at the title of the essay and the first line of each paragraph. Create a guiding question for your reading.
2. Skim the first paragraph. What do you think is Dai's purpose in this essay?
3. Is there a smell that brings a memory to your mind?



Read and annotate this essay using the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Comparison and Contrast on page 230.

habituate to: to get used to

idiosyncratic: peculiar or unique to one place, individual, or thing

endogenous: coming from within

There are many things that distinguish China's street etiquette from the U.S. equivalent: For example, China forbids honking except in the most extreme cases. In the United States, there are no car horns to **habituate to**, nor are there so many people with so many voices. However, what is most distinctive about China is its smell.

2 Simply put, China smells different than America. It is a weird and completely overwhelming phenomenon that seems wholly inexplicable in scientific terms. How can one country smell different from another? China and the United States are both vast countries with obviously different, **idiosyncratic** odors in separate regions of each. The American Northeast smells of the sea, and the Midwest, dry cornfields. What is so distinctive between the two that, without opening my eyes, I can tell which country is which? Let me explain. The smell of China carries a distinctive musk that is the combination of age and non-ammonia cleaning supplies. America, on the other hand, smells clean—literally, and not necessarily in a good way. Cleaning detergents are used almost ubiquitously in America, while relatively rarely in China. In the States, the complex chemical combinations in cleaning agents destroy almost any **endogenous** smell of the environment, leaving only a hint of pine or lavender, or whatever oil extract the manufacturer has dropped into the mixture.

3 In every grocery store in America there is always an entire row of cleaning supplies, each with bottles of 409 or Scrubbing Bubbles lined neatly on steel shelves. In China, there are no comparable brands; there is classic soap and there is liquid soap: no ammonia in sight. Such a difference in cleaning protocol has a dramatic effect on the resulting odor of each country.

4 The reason why the difference in odor between the two countries is so distinctive and apparent is because **olfaction** evokes strong emotional memories. Biologically, the olfactory system is one of the few senses in the human body that has a direct connection to the part of the brain that is in charge of emotional memories, the amygdala. The olfactory system's mitral cells and olfactory receptor neurons help send information about scents to the amygdala. This is the reason why the smell of cinnamon evokes more memories and emotions than just the sight of cinnamon. It also elicits memories of Christmas morning or the cinnamon rolls after a Thanksgiving dinner. In comparison, few other sensory faculties call to mind a similar distinctive memory. Hearing, for example, does not evoke as powerful memories as olfaction, or else, every single time we heard something we would be reliving the past.

olfaction: the act of smelling or the sense of smell

5 To me, America smells like driving alone down a road really fast with the wind in your hair; it is freedom. China smells like getting breakfast with my grandmother at dawn in the street market just as it is beginning to bustle; it is nostalgia. As a Chinese American, it is always difficult to distinguish between which part of my heritage is which. I have always wondered what I would have been like if I stayed with my grandmother and had gotten breakfast with her everyday at the street market. Would I still be as argumentative as I am today? Or would I be more pliable?

6 The distinction between my identity as both Chinese and American is even harder now that I am on a service project in China. I alternate sporadically as needed between my personalities as a Duke student and another Chinese pedestrian on the street. I converse normally with the rest of my service group as I would on Duke's campus, but the moment I turn to speak to a native or to translate something from English to Chinese, I become one of the more than 1.3 billion people who populate China.

7 Right now, the unique scent of China is correlated with a set of childhood memories. Once in a while, under the influence of a particular familiar waft of odor, memories of my childhood will rush me back in time. But memory is **malleable**. And soon, new memories will become associated with the scents of old, for better or for worse. I hope it will be for the better.

malleable: flexible; easily changed



Review your reading. Make sure you can answer these questions:

1. What is the answer to your guiding question?
2. Does Dai's main point address only the differences between China and the United States? Explain.
3. If you had to choose a different title for this essay, what would you choose?
4. *Write to improve reading.* Using your annotations, write a summary of the essay. Make sure that the summary captures the main point and the major supporting ideas in your own words. Use strong descriptive verbs in each sentence (see p. 96).

Preview

Read

Review

Reflect and Respond

1. Does the writer use point-by-point or whole-by-whole organization?
2. *Make inferences.* Which smell does the author prefer, the smell of China or the smell of the United States?
3. Why is smell so closely connected to our memories? Why does the writer explain the biological reason for the power of smell?
4. The writer uses the contrasting smells of the United States and China to explain something about herself. What does she show her readers about her identity?

Read and Analyze Professional Comparison and Contrast

Dave Barry

The Ugly Truth about Beauty

Preview

1. Skim the title, the author information, and the first three paragraphs. What will be compared and contrasted in this essay?
2. What do you think the author's purpose might be?
3. In the first three paragraphs, Barry addresses his reader with second-person pronouns (*you*). To whom is he speaking? How do you know?
4. What is your guiding question for this reading?

Read and annotate this essay carefully, following the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Comparison and Contrast on page 230.

* * *



WALTER MCBRIDE/GETTY IMAGES

Born in 1947 in Armonk, New York, Dave Barry earned a B.A. from Haverford College. He then worked for several years as a newspaper reporter and a lecturer on business writing before discovering his talent as a humor columnist. The columns he wrote for the *Miami Herald* from 1983 to 2004 have been collected in numerous books. Barry's observations on American life won him the Pulitzer Prize for Commentary in 1988. In "The Ugly Truth about Beauty," first published in the *Miami Herald* in 1998, Barry compares and contrasts men's and women's beauty routines. The essay humorously highlights differences in the ways that men and women view themselves.

If you're a man, at some point a woman will ask you how she looks.

2 "How do I look?" she'll ask.

3 You must be careful how you answer this question. The best technique is to form an honest yet sensitive opinion, then collapse on the floor with some kind of fatal seizure. Trust me, this is the easiest way out. Because you will never come up with the right answer.

4 The problem is that women generally do not think of their looks in the same way that men do. Most men form an opinion of how they look in the seventh grade, and they stick to it for the rest of their lives. Some men form the opinion that they are irresistible stud muffins, and they do not change this opinion even when their faces sag and their noses bloat to the size of eggplants and their eyebrows grow together to form what appears to be a giant forehead-dwelling tropical caterpillar.

5 Most men, I believe, think of themselves as average-looking. Men will think this even if their faces cause heart failure in cattle at a range of 300 yards. Being average does not bother them; average is fine for men. This is why men never ask anybody how they look. Their primary form of beauty care is to shave themselves, which is essentially the same form of beauty care that they give to their lawns. If, at the end of his four-minute daily beauty regimen, a man has managed to wipe most of the shaving cream out of his hair and is not bleeding too badly, he feels that he has done all he can, so he stops thinking about his appearance and devotes his mind to more critical issues, such as the Super Bowl.

6 Women do not look at themselves this way. If I had to express, in three words, what most women think about their appearance, those words would be: "not good enough." No matter how attractive a woman may appear to others, when she looks at herself in the mirror, she thinks, "woof." She thinks that at any moment a municipal animal-control officer is going to throw a net over her and haul her off to the shelter.

7 Why do women have such low self-esteem? There are many complex psychological and societal reasons, by which I mean “Barbie.” Girls grow up playing with a doll proportioned such that, if it were human, it would be seven feet tall and weigh 81 pounds, of which 53 pounds would be bosoms. This is a difficult appearance standard to live up to, especially when you contrast it with the standard set for little boys by their dolls . . . excuse me, by their action figures. Most of the action figures that my son played with when he was little were hideous looking. For example, he was fond of an action figure (part of the He-Man series) called “Buzz-Off,” who was part human, part flying insect. Buzz-Off was not a looker. But he was extremely self-confident. You could not imagine Buzz-Off saying to the other action figures, “Do you think these wings make my hips look big?”

8 But women grow up thinking they need to look like Barbie, which for most women is impossible, although there is a multibillion-dollar beauty industry devoted to convincing women that they must try. I once saw an Oprah show wherein supermodel Cindy Crawford dispensed makeup tips to the studio audience. Cindy had all these middle-aged women apply beauty products to their faces; she stressed how important it was to apply them in a certain way, using the tips of their fingers. All the women dutifully did this, even though it was obvious to any sane observer that no matter how carefully they applied these products, they would never look remotely like Cindy Crawford, who is some kind of genetic mutation.

9 I’m not saying that men are superior. I’m just saying that you’re not going to get a group of middle-aged men to sit in a room and apply cosmetics to themselves under the instruction of Brad Pitt, in hopes of looking more like him. Men would realize that this task was pointless and demeaning. They would find some way to bolster their self-esteem that did not require looking like Brad Pitt. They would say to Brad, “Oh YEAH? Well what do you know about LAWN CARE, pretty boy?”

10 Of course many women will argue that the reason they become obsessed with trying to look like Cindy Crawford is that men, being as shallow as a drop of spit, WANT women to look that way. To which I have two responses:

1. Hey, just because WE’RE idiots, that does not mean YOU have to be; and
2. Men don’t even notice 97 percent of the beauty efforts you make anyway. Take fingernails. The average woman spends 5,000 hours per year worrying about her fingernails; I have never once, in more than 40 years of listening to men talk about women, heard a man say, “She has a nice set of fingernails!” Many men would not notice if a woman had upward of four hands.

11 Anyway, to get back to my original point: If you’re a man, and a woman asks you how she looks, you’re in big trouble. Obviously, you can’t say she looks bad. But you also can’t say that she looks great, because she’ll think you’re lying, because she has spent countless hours, with the help of the multibillion-dollar beauty industry, obsessing about the differences between herself and Cindy Crawford. Also, she suspects that you’re not qualified to judge anybody’s appearance. This is because you have shaving cream in your hair.

Check Comprehension

1. What is Barry contrasting?
2. What are the points of contrast Barry presents?
3. How has he organized the essay?
4. In paragraphs 8 and 9, Barry uses details to emphasize the differences between men and women. What are the specific examples used to make the point in those paragraphs?

Think Critically

Would Barry agree or disagree with the following statements? Explain your answer.

1. Men and women have different emotional responses to most situations. **Disagree**
2. Toys help shape a child's perception of himself or herself. **Agree**
3. Women shouldn't be so concerned with their looks. **Agree**
4. Do you think Barry's representation of women (or men) is fair and accurate? Explain.

Summarize

Using the guidelines from Chapter 6 and your annotations, write a summary of Barry's essay. Remember that your summary will include the main point and major support (points of contrast), written in your own words.

Writing Strategies in Action: A Tone of Comic Exaggeration

Tone is the attitude of an author toward the subject he or she is writing about. Tone also helps a reader know how to interpret what a writer says. It is important for a reader to understand a writer's tone; if readers miss clues about the writer's tone, they may misinterpret the essay. (For more on tone, see Chapter 6.) Writers have several techniques for creating tone, including word choice and exaggeration.

Dave Barry is known for writing with humor and exaggeration, even when the topic he addresses is serious. For example, in paragraph 3 of "The Ugly Truth about Beauty," Barry says that a man who is asked how a woman looks must form "an honest yet sensitive opinion, then collapse on the floor with some kind of fatal seizure." Obviously, Barry does not really expect his readers to resort to medical emergencies in response to a woman's question about her appearance. His exaggeration allows him to emphasize his point: because men and women think differently about their appearances, it is very difficult for a man to answer the question appropriately.

Think About Comic Exaggeration

1. Find two additional examples of humorous exaggeration in Barry's essay.
2. Quote these examples and cite them appropriately.
3. Use these quotations in a paragraph that answers this question: how does Barry use humor to help make his point?

Explore Grammar: Using Quotes within Quotes

Look at the following quote from Barry's essay:

No matter how attractive a woman may appear to others, when she looks at herself in the mirror, she thinks, "woof."

When the material you are quoting includes quotation marks, use single quotation marks where the original has double quotation marks, as in the following example:

Barry says, "No matter how attractive a woman may appear to others, when she looks at herself in the mirror, she thinks, 'woof'" (235).

Use Quotes within Quotes

Read the following questions. In your answers, quote the passage listed. Make sure that you use single quotes for material that has quotation marks in Barry's original.

1. Would male action figures be concerned about their appearance? Passage to quote: "You could not imagine Buzz-Off saying to the other action figures, 'Do you think these wings make my hips look big?'" (para. 7)
2. According to Barry, do men connect appearance and self-esteem? Passage to quote: "They would find some way to bolster their self-esteem that did not require looking like Brad Pitt. They would say to Brad, 'Oh YEAH? Well what do you know about LAWN CARE, pretty boy?'" (para. 9)
3. According to Barry, do men notice all parts of a woman's typical beauty routine? Passage to quote: "The average woman spends 5,000 hours per year worrying about her fingernails; I have never once, in more than 40 years of listening to men talk about women, heard a man say, 'She has a nice set of fingernails!'" (para. 10)

Think, Discuss, and Respond

1. Barry addresses the differences between men and women in relation to physical appearance. What is another area in which men and women behave in different ways? Write an essay in which you explore these gender-based differences.
2. Choose a female (or male) role model, hero, or superstar from today and one from twenty-five years ago. Are the expectations similar or different? Compare and/or contrast the concept of role model then and now.
3. In paragraph 7, Barry emphasizes the differences between male and female approaches to beauty by focusing on toys. Write a paragraph or an essay in which you answer the following questions: Why does Barry focus on toys? Do his specific examples help him make his point? Why or why not? Would his point have worked as well if he had chosen a superhero action figure such as Captain America, Superman, or Spider-Man? Explain your answer.

Judith Ortiz Cofer

The Myth of the Latin Woman: I Just Met a Girl Named Maria

Preview

1. Skim the title, the author information, and the first three paragraphs. What will be compared and contrasted in this essay?
2. What do you think the author's purpose might be?
3. What kind of myths do you think Cofer refers to in the title? Explain.
4. Who do you think is the audience for this piece? (Hint: Think carefully about the title. To whom is Cofer speaking?)
5. What will be your guiding question for this reading?

Read and annotate this essay carefully, following the Guidelines for Reading and Annotating Comparison and Contrast on page 230.



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Judith Ortiz Cofer was a Puerto Rican author and the Regents' and Franklin Professor of English and Creative Writing at the University of Georgia, where she had taught since 1984. She earned a B.A. in English from Augusta College and an M.A. in English from Florida Atlantic University. In 2007, she was awarded an honorary doctorate in human letters from Lehman University in New York City. Cofer's works span across literary genres, including books of poetry, novels, autobiographical writing, and collections of short stories and essays. Her work has appeared in numerous literary journals, and it is often anthologized and included in textbooks.

tenor: the male voice that falls between bass and alto

"Maria": a song from *West Side Story* about one of the main Puerto Rican characters

West Side Story: a 1957 Broadway musical, made into a film in 1961

Rita Moreno: a Puerto Rican actress who played in *West Side Story*

microcosm: a world in miniature

casas: Spanish for "houses"

bodega: Spanish for "small grocery store"

Marlo Thomas: an American actress who played a modern single woman on the television show *That Girl*, which ran from 1966 to 1971

prospective: likely to become; expected

On a bus to London from Oxford University, where I was earning some graduate credits one summer, a young man, obviously fresh from a pub, approached my seat. With both hands over his heart, he went down on his knees in the aisle and broke into an Irish **tenor's** rendition of "Maria" from *West Side Story*. I was not amused. "Maria" had followed me to London, reminding me of a prime fact of my life: You can leave the island of Puerto Rico, master the English language, and travel as far as you can, but if you're a Latina, especially one who so clearly belongs to **Rita Moreno's** gene pool, the island travels with you.

2 Growing up in New Jersey and wanting most of all to belong, I lived in two completely different worlds. My parents designed our life as a **microcosm** of their **casas** on the island—we spoke Spanish, ate Puerto Rican food bought at the **bodega**, and practiced strict Catholicism complete with Sunday mass in Spanish.

3 I was kept under tight surveillance by my parents, since my virtue and modesty were, by their cultural equation, the same as their honor. As teenagers, my friends and I were lectured constantly on how to behave as proper *senoritas*. But it was a conflicting message we received, since our Puerto Rican mothers also encouraged us to look and act like women by dressing us in clothes our Anglo schoolmates and their mothers found too "mature" and flashy. I often felt humiliated when I appeared at an American friend's birthday party wearing a dress more suitable for a semiformal. At Puerto Rican festivities, neither the music nor the colors we wore could be too loud.

4 I remember Career Day in high school, when our teachers told us to come dressed as if for a job interview. That morning, I agonized in front of my closet, trying to figure out what a "career girl" would wear, because the only model I had was **Marlo Thomas** on TV. To me and my Puerto Rican girlfriends, dressing up meant wearing our mothers' ornate jewelry and clothing.

5 At school that day, the teachers assailed us for wearing "everything at once"—meaning too much jewelry and too many accessories. And it was painfully obvious that the other students in their tailored skirts and silk blouses thought we were hopeless and vulgar. The way they looked at us was a taste of the cultural clash that awaited us in the real world, where **prospective** employers

and men on the street would often misinterpret our tight skirts and bright colors as a come-on.

6 It is custom, not chromosomes, that leads us to choose scarlet over pale pink. Our mothers had grown up on a tropical island where the natural environment was a riot of primary colors, where showing your skin was one way to keep cool as well as to look sexy. On the island, women felt free to dress and move provocatively since they were protected by the traditions and laws of a Spanish Catholic system of morality and **machismo**, the main rule of which was, “You may look at my sister, but if you touch her, I will kill you.” The extended family and church structure provided them with a circle of safety on the island; if a man “wronged” a girl, everyone would close in to save her family honor.

machismo: a strong or exaggerated sense of manliness or power

7 Off-island, signals often get mixed. When a Puerto Rican girl who is dressed in her idea of what is attractive meets a man from mainstream culture who has been trained to react to certain types of clothing as a sexual signal, a clash is likely to take place. She is seen as a Hot Tamale, a sexual firebrand. I learned this lesson at my first formal dance when my date leaned over and painfully planted a sloppy, overeager kiss on my mouth. When I didn’t respond with sufficient passion, he said in a resentful tone, “I thought you Latin girls were supposed to mature early.” It was the first time I would feel like a fruit or vegetable—I was supposed to ripen, not just grow into womanhood like other girls.

8 These stereotypes, though rarer, still surface in my life. I recently stayed at a classy metropolitan hotel. After having dinner with a friend, I was returning to my room when a middle-aged man in a tuxedo stepped directly into my path. With his champagne glass extended toward me, he exclaimed, “*Evita!*”

Evita: a musical and film about Eva Perón, Argentina’s first lady from 1946 to 1952

9 Blocking my way, he bellowed the song “Don’t Cry for Me, Argentina.” Playing to the gathering crowd, he began to sing loudly, a ditty to the tune of “La Bamba”—except the lyrics were about a girl named Maria whose exploits all rhymed with her name and gonorrhea.

10 I knew that this same man—probably a corporate executive, even worldly by most standards—would never have regaled a white woman with a dirty song in public. But to him, I was just a character in his universe of “others,” all cartoons.

11 Still, I am one of the lucky ones. There are thousands of Latinas without the privilege of the education that my parents gave me. For them, every day is a struggle against the misconceptions **perpetuated** by the myth of the Latina as a whore, domestic worker, or criminal.

perpetuated: preserved

12 Rather than fight these **pervasive** stereotypes, I try to replace them with a more interesting set of realities. I travel around the United States reading from my books of poetry and my novel. With the stories I tell, the dreams and fears I examine in my work, I try to get my audience past the particulars of my skin color, my accent, or my clothes.

pervasive: widespread

13 I once wrote a poem in which I called Latinas “God’s brown daughters.” It is really a prayer of sorts, for communication and respect. In it, Latin women pray “in Spanish to an Anglo God with a Jewish heritage,” and they are “fervently hoping that if not omnipotent, at least He be bilingual.”

Check Comprehension

1. What is the writer's main point?
2. What is she contrasting in this essay?
3. Why does she describe people singing to her?
4. What is the writer's conclusion?
5. What is the stereotype that the author says she had to confront?

Think Critically

Determine if the following statements are true or false, based on your understanding of the essay.

1. Cofer's parents were stricter than the parents of her friends. **False**
2. The Catholic church was an important part of Cofer's childhood and culture. **True**
3. Cofer resents the way Latina women are presented in American movies and musicals. **True**

Paraphrase

How are Latinas (Latin American women) stereotyped, according to Cofer? Choose at least two examples from her essay that show a common stereotype, and paraphrase these examples. Be sure to use a signal phrase and a citation with your paraphrases.

Writing Strategies in Action: Use Demonstrative Words to Create Cohesion

Cofer creates a complicated essay, contrasting standards for female dress and behavior in her Puerto Rican culture with those of Anglo culture in the United States. She also looks at how those differences have led to stereotyping of Latina women. She provides multiple examples throughout to illustrate her key points. To help readers follow the examples she presents, Cofer relies on **demonstrative** words throughout the essay: *this*, *that*, *these*, and *those*. (For more on these words, see Chapter 20.) These words act like pointing words that tie ideas together. In other words, they create cohesion, which means that the ideas in one sentence flow logically and smoothly to the next. For instance, look at the following example. The demonstrative words are in italics:

- I remember Career Day in high school, when our teachers told us to come dressed as if for a job interview. *That* morning, I agonized in front of my closet...
- At school *that* day, the teachers assailed us for wearing "everything at once..."

The word "that" helps the reader connect these sentences to "Career Day."

Think about Demonstrative Words

Find at least three additional examples of demonstrative words in Cofer's essay. Draw arrows to show how these words tie the paragraph together.

Build Vocabulary: Recognize Borrowed Words and Proper Names

Cofer provides many details to help the reader visualize the differences she experienced growing up as the child of Puerto Rican immigrants in New Jersey. In some cases, the details involve words that are borrowed from Spanish, including *casas*, *bodega*, and *machismo*.

1. What does the use of these words add to the essay?
2. What strategy can you use to understand non-English words—or English words borrowed from other languages—in an essay?

In other instances, Cofer refers to the musicals *West Side Story* and *Evita*, along with other proper nouns (for more on proper nouns, see Chapter 8).

3. Why does she mention these works?
4. Are you familiar with the music or story of either production? If so, what does your experience add to your understanding of the essay?
5. If you are not familiar with these references, what strategy can you use to understand Cofer's point in mentioning them?

Think, Discuss, and Respond

1. How does Cofer suggest she will respond to stereotypes? Do you think her response can make a difference? Explain.
2. Cofer is writing about stereotypes of Latinas. Where do these images and ideas come from? How do they distort reality?
3. According to Cofer, she has a privilege that many other Latinas do not. What is her privilege, and what does this advantage allow her to do?

Extend and Connect: Write Your Own Comparison and Contrast

1. Write about a time when people have misunderstood you. Contrast the misunderstanding with the reality of the situation, and try to understand the source of the mistake.
2. Cofer focuses primarily on misunderstandings or myths about Latinas, but there are many other stereotypes in our culture as well. Choose and describe a common stereotype that you think is mistaken; then, compare and contrast that stereotypical image or idea with a more accurate portrait or reality.
3. In his essay, Dave Barry suggests that toy manufacturers help promote unrealistic ideals of female beauty. Do you think toys can also perpetuate or promote

the sorts of stereotypes described by Cofer in her essay? Explain your answer in an essay.

4. Both Rui Dai and Judith Ortiz Cofer contrast different cultures. Like Amy Tan (Chapter 7), these authors discuss how the differences between cultures have affected their lives. If you have lived in two places or in two cultures, what differences have you seen? How have those differences affected your life? Explain your answer in a comparison/contrast essay.

CHECKLIST

Writing a Comparison and Contrast



NARROW AND EXPLORE YOUR TOPIC (see Chapter 2)

- ☐ Make the topic more specific.
- ☐ Use prewriting techniques to get ideas about your narrow topic.



DRAFT A TOPIC SENTENCE OR THESIS STATEMENT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ State your two subjects, your main idea, and your purpose for comparing and contrasting.

SUPPORT YOUR POINT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ Discover points of comparison/contrast and details about each one.

WRITE A FULL DRAFT (see Chapter 4)

- ☐ Make a plan following either point-by-point or whole-to-whole organization.
- ☐ Include the topic sentence (paragraph), an introduction, a thesis (essay), and all the support points.
- ☐ Add a concluding sentence or concluding paragraph.



REVISE YOUR DRAFT (see Chapter 5)

- ☐ Make sure you have covered the Four Basics of Good Comparison and Contrast.
- ☐ Make sure your readers have all the information they need to clearly see the similarities or differences.
- ☐ Make sure you have included transitions to move readers smoothly from one subject or point of comparison/contrast to the next.



EDIT YOUR REVISED DRAFT (see Chapter 5)

- ☐ Correct mistakes in grammar, spelling, punctuation, and word usage.
- ☐ Make sure your document is formatted correctly.